Ans : (c) The Establishment of Home Rule League was originally planned by Annie Besant. She founded it in September 1916 and through her newspaper 'Commonweal' and 'New India', she publicized the programs of the league. She was elected President at the 1917 INC session. The Theosophical Society was founded in Adyar (Chennai) in the year 1882 by Colonel H.S. Olcott and Madame Blavatsky.

12. The Ilbert Bill controversy was related to the
(a) imposition of certain restrictions to carry arms by the Indians
(b) imposition of restrictions on newspapers and magazines published in Indian languages
(c) removal of disqualificaions imposed on the Indian magistrates with regard to the trial of the Europeans
(d) removal of a duty on imported cotton cloth

Ans : (c) The Ilbert Bill was introduced in 1883 by Viceroy Ripon to amend the existing laws to allow the Indian judges to try British offenders in criminal cases at the district level.

• Freedom Struggle & National Movement

13. The people of India agitated against the arrival of Simon Commission because :
(a) Indians never wanted the review of the working of the Act of 1919
(b) Simon Commission recommended the abolition of Dyarchy (Diarchy) in the Provinces
(c) there was no Indian member in the Simon Commission
(d) the Simon Commission suggested the partition of the country

Ans : (c) All the members of the 7 members of the Simon Commission Constituted under the chairmanship of Simon were English; hence Congressmen called it white commission. Then an annual session of the congress held in Madras on 27 December 1927, presided over by M.A. Ansari, it was decided to complete boycott the Simon Commission.

14. Quit India Movement was launched in response to
(a) Cabinet Mission Plan
(b) Cripps Proposals
(c) Simon Commission Report
(d) Wavell Plan

Ans : (b) Quit India Movement was launched in August 1942. It came in response to the Cripps' Proposal. The Cripps Mission came to India in March 1942 and was headed by Sir Stafford Cripps. It had come to negotiate a proposal for self-government for India in return for cooperation in the World War II effort. Commenting on Cripps proposals Gandhi said, it is a post-dated cheque of a failing bank.

GEOGRAPHY OF INDIA

• Physical Structure/Drainage System/ Human Geography

15. Consider the following pairs:

Tribe		State
1. Limboo (Limbu)	–	Sikkim
2. Karbi	–	Himachal Pradesh
3. Dongaria Kondh	–	Odisha
4. Bonda	–	Tamilnadu

Which of the above pairs are correctly matched?
(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 4 only
(c) 1,3 and 4 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans : (a) Correct matches are –

Tribe	State
Limboo	Sikkim
Karbi	Assam
Dongaria Kondh	Odisha
Bonda	Odisha

16. The narmada river flows to the west, while most other large peninsular rivers flow to the east. Why?
1. It occupies a linear rift valley.
2. It flows between theVindhyas and the Satpuras.
3. The land slopes to the west from Central India
Select the correct answer using the codes given below
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) None

Ans : (a) The Narmada and the Tapi flow through the rift valley. Statement 3 is wrong, as land slopes to the east in this region. Statement 2 is factually correct however it is not the reason for the rivers to flow to the west.

• Monsoon, Forest, Soil, Irrigation Projects and Agriculture

17. Which of the following leaf modifications occurs/occur in desert areas to inhibit water loss
1. Hard and waxy leaves
2. Tiny leaves or no leaves
3. Thorns instead of leaves
Select the correct answer using the codes given below :
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1,2 and 3

Ans : (d) To prevent water loss in the desert, there are three factors which are as follows- Hard and Waxy leaf, small leaf or foliage, Thorn in place of the leaf. Since there is a shortage of water in the desert land, the plants do not get enough water. In order to maintain water compatibility, the emission of water is minimal, for this the bark of desert plants turn into hard foliage and leaf into a thorn.

18. Which of the following statements regarding laterite soils of India are correct.
1. They are generally red in colour.
2. They are rich in nitrogen and Potash
3. They are well-developed in Rajasthan and UP.
4. Tapioca and cashew nuts grow well on these soils.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below :
(a) 1,2 and 3 (b) 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1 and 4 (d) 2 and 3 only

Ans : (c) Statement 2 is wrong as these soil are poor in nitrogen and phosphate. Statement 3 is wrong as laterite is not found in U.P. and Rajasthan. Red Laterite soils found in Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh and Kerala are more suitable for tree crops like cashewnut and Tapioca.

• Minerals, Power Resources, Industry and Trade

19. Which of the following is/are the characteristic/characteristics of Indian coal ?
1. High ash content
2. Low sulphur content
3. Low ash fusion temperature
Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (a) Indian coal has a very high ash content, which varies from 35 to 45% as compared to 15% in other parts of the world. Indian coal also has a high ash fusion temperature of 1500ºC. However, Indian coal has a low sulphur content at about 0.5%.

20. Consider the following statements :
1. Natural gas occurs in the Gondwana beds
2. Mica occurs in abundance in Kodarma.
3. Dharwars are famous for petroleum.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 (d) None

Ans : (b) Natural gas is obtained along with oil in all the oil fields but exclusive reserves have been located along the eastern coast (Tamil Nadu, Odisha and Andhra Pradesh) as well as Tripura, Rajashtan and off-shore wells in Gujarat and Maharashtra. Crude petroleum occurs in sedimentary rocks of the tertiary period. Koderma (Jharkhand) is a popular site of mining for Mica.

WORLD GEOGRAPHY

• Universe & Solar System

21. Variations in the length of daytime and night time from season to season are due to
(a) the earth's rotation on its axis
(b) the earth's revolution round the sun in an elliptical manner
(c) latitudinal position of the place
(d) revolution of the earth on a tilted axis

Ans : (d) On its path around the Sun the earths axis always remains inclined to one side. Because of this constant inclination in one direction. The Northern Hemisphere remains inclined towards the sun or faces the sun during one half of the year. Therefore, a larger part of this hemisphere receives sunlight. Every point in this hemisphere takes a longer time to go out of the sunlight, with the result that the days are longer. In contrast, the Southern Hemisphere is away from the sun. It, therefore, has shorter days and longer nights. During the other half of the year, the Southern Hemisphere is inclined towards the Sun. Hence, it has longer days and shorter nights.

• Lithosphere

22. The annual range of temperature in the interior of the continents is high as compared to coastal areas. What is / are the reason/ reasons ?
1. Thermal difference between land and water
2. Variation in altitude between continents and oceans
3. Presence of strong winds in the interior
4. Heavy rains in the interior as compared to coasts
Select the correct answer using the codes given below :
(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans : (a) Lands heats up and cool down very fast as compared to the water. Areas in the interior of India are far away from the moderating influence of the Sea. Such areas have extremes of climate. Statement 2 is wrong as there may or may not be much difference between the altitudes of land and ocean. Statement 3 is wrong as winds do not contribute enough to the variations in temperature. Statement 4 is wrong as coastal regions receive more rainfall.

23. Which one the of the following pairs is correctly matched ?

Geographical Feature		Region
(a) Abyssinian Plateau	:	Arabia
(b) Atlas Mountains		North-Western Africa
(c) Guiana Highlands		South-Western Africa
(d) Okavango Basin		Patagonia

Ans : (b) The correct Match are–

Geographical Feature		Region
Abyssinian Plateau	–	Ethiopia
Atlas Mountains	–	North-Western Africa
Guiana Highlands	–	North-East South America
Okavango Basin	–	South-west Africa

24. On the planet earth, most of the freshwater exists as ice caps and glaciers. Out of the remaining freshwater, the largest proportion
(a) is found in atmosphere as moisture and clouds
(b) is found in freshwater lakes and rivers
(c) exists as ground water
(d) exists as soil moisture